

MYOSOTIS

Forget-me-not

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials, and clump or mat-forming perennials, grown for their flowers. Most species are good for rock gardens and screes; *M. scorpioides* is best grown as a marginal water plant. The dwarf perennials are usually short-lived, but self-seed freely. Fully hardy. Most prefer sun or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring. **M. alpestris**, syn. *M. rupicola* (Alpine forget-me-not), illus. p.356. **M. australis**. Short-lived, tuft-forming perennial. H 5in (12cm), S 3in (8cm). Has ovate, rough-textured leaves and, in summer, produces tight sprays of open funnel-shaped, yellow or white flowers. Good for a scree. Z3–8 **M. palustris**. See *M. scorpioides*. **M. rupicola**. See *M. alpestris*. **M. scorpioides ‘Mermaid’**, syn. *M. palustris* (Water forget-me-not), illus. p.441. **M. sylvatica ‘Blue Ball’** illus. p.315. **‘Mon Amie Blue’** is a low, mound-forming, short-lived perennial. H and S 6–8in (15–20cm). Produces ovate to lance-shaped, gray-green leaves and dense heads of saucer-shaped, light blue flowers in summer. Good for massed plantings. **Sylva Series** illus. p.313. **‘Blue Sylva’**, H 8in (20cm), is low and spreading and produces bright blue flowers. Z3–8

Myrceugenia apiculata. See *Luma apiculata*.

MYRICA

MYRICACEAE

Genus of deciduous and evergreen, usually suckering shrubs and trees found in moist soils worldwide. *M. gale* is useful for a bog garden and very effective when grown in groups. Fully hardy to frost hardy. They have alternate, lance-shaped to ovate, usually aromatic, dark green leaves. Needs humus-rich, moist soil, and a position in full sun or partial shade. **M. gale** (Bog myrtle) illus. p.162.

MYRIOPHYLLUM

Milfoil

HALORAGACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, or annual, submerged water plants, grown for their foliage. Most species are ideal as depositories for fish spawn. Fully hardy to frost tender. Requires full sun. Spreads widely; keep in check by removing excess growth as required. Propagate by root cuttings in spring or summer. **M. hippuroides** (Western milfoil). Deciduous, perennial, spreading, submerged water plant with thin stems. S indefinite. Produces a dense mass of small, feathery, pale green leaves. Tiny, greenish-cream flowers are borne from the axils of the emergent leaves in summer. Suitable for a cold-water aquarium. Z9–11 **M. proserpinacoides**. See *M. aquaticum*. **M. verticillatum** (Whorled water milfoil) illus. p.442.

MYRRHIS

Sweet Cicely

APIACEAE/UMBELLIFERAE

Genus of one species of summer-flowering perennial. Fully hardy. Requires a position in partial shade and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or spring. **M. odorata** (Sweet Cicely) illus. p.230.

MYRSINE

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, with inconspicuous flowers, grown mainly for their foliage. Also bears decorative fruits, to obtain which plants of both sexes must be grown. Suitable for rock and peat gardens. Frost hardy to frost tender, but in cold areas requires shelter. Requires a position in sun or shade and in any fertile, well-drained soil other than a shallow, chalky one. Propagate by seed in fall or semiripe cuttings in summer. **M. africana** (African boxwood, Cape myrtle). Very slow-growing, evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 30in (75cm). Small, glossy, dark green leaves are aromatic and rounded. Tiny, yellowish-brown flowers in late spring are succeeded by spherical, pale blue fruits. Z9–11

MYRTILLOCACTUS

CACTACEAE

Genus of shrubby or treelike, perennial cacti with ribbed, spiny, blue-green stems. Bears star-shaped flowers that open at night. Frost tender. Needs a sunny, well-drained site. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring. **M. geometrizans** (Blue candle) illus. p.489.

MYRTUS

Myrtle

MYRTACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, sometimes treelike, grown for their flowers, fruits, and aromatic foliage. Frost hardy; in cold areas plant against a warm, sunny wall. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. May be pruned in spring. Propagate by seed in a cold frame in fall or semiripe cuttings in late summer. **M. apiculata**. See *Luma apiculata*. **M. bullata**. See *Lophomyrtus bullata*. **M. chequen**. See *Luma chequen*. **M. communis** (Common myrtle) illus. p.122. **‘Jenny Reitenbach’** see *M.c.* subsp. *tarentina*. **‘Microphylla’** see *M.c.* subsp. *tarentina*. **subsp. tarentina** (syn. *M.c.* ‘Jenny Reitenbach’, *M.c.* ‘Microphylla’; Tarentum myrtle) is a compact, bushy shrub. H and S 6ft (2m). Bears small leaves that are narrowly ovate, glossy and dark green. Produces fragrant, saucer-shaped, pink-tinted, white flowers, each with a dense cluster of stamens, from mid-to late summer or early fall, followed by round, white fruits. Very wind-resistant and good for hedging in mild areas. Z8–11 **M. luma**. See *Luma apiculata*. **‘Glanleam Gold’** see *Luma apiculata* ‘Glanleam Gold’. **M. ugni**. See *Ugni molinae*.

N

NANDINA

BERBERIDACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen or semievergreen, summer-flowering shrub, grown for its foliage and flowers. Frost hardy. Prefers a sheltered, sunny site and fertile, well-drained but not too dry soil. On established plants prune untidy, old stems to base in spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer. **N. domestica** (Heavenly bamboo). Evergreen or semievergreen, upright, elegant shrub. H 6ft (2m), S 5ft (1.5m). Leaves have narrowly lance-shaped, dark green leaflets, purplish-red when young and in fall-winter. Large panicles of small, star-shaped, white flowers, with large yellow anthers, borne in midsummer are followed in warm climates by spherical, red fruits. Z9–11. **‘Fire Power’** illus. p.143. **‘Richmond’** is vigorous and free-fruiting, with bright red foliage in fall and winter.

NARCISSUS

Daffodil

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of bulbs, grown for their ornamental flowers. Daffodils usually have linear, basal leaves and a spread of up to 8in (20cm). Each flower has a trumpet or cup (the corona) and petals (botanically known as perianth segments). Fully hardy, except where otherwise stated. Prefer sun or light shade and well-drained soil, but Div.8 cultivars (see below) prefer a sunny site and tolerate lighter soils. Deadhead flowers as they fade and remove the spent foliage during midsummer. Most cultivars increase naturally by offsets; dense clumps should be divided no sooner than 6 weeks after flowering every 3–5 years. Propagate species by fresh seed in late summer or fall. Narcissus yellow stripe virus, basal rot, slugs, large narcissus fly, and bulb and stem eelworm may cause problems. ☉ Contact with sap may aggravate skin allergies or irritate skin. See feature panel pp.404–405. Horticulturally, *Narcissus* is split into the following divisions.

- Div. 1 Trumpet**—usually solitary flowers each have a trumpet that is as long as, or longer than, the petals. Early to late spring-flowering.
- Div. 2 Large-cupped**—solitary flowers each have a cup at least one-third the length of, but shorter than, the petals. Spring-flowering.
- Div. 3 Small-cupped**—flowers are often borne singly; each has a cup not more than one-third the length of the petals. Spring- or early summer-flowering.
- Div. 4 Double**—most have solitary, large, fully or semidouble flowers, sometimes scented, with cup or both cup and petals replaced by petaloid structures. Some have smaller flowers, borne in clusters of 4 or more, which are often sweetly fragrant. Spring- or early summer-flowering.

- Div. 5 Triandrus**—nodding flowers, with short, sometimes straight-sided cups and narrow, reflexed petals, are borne 2–6 per stem. Flowers are produced in spring.
- Div. 6 Cyclamineus**—flowers are borne usually 1 or 2 per stem, with cup that may be flanged and often longer than those of Div.5. Petals are narrow, pointed and reflexed. Early to mid-spring-flowering.
- Div. 7 Jonquil and Apodanthus**—sweetly scented flowers are borne usually 2 or more per stem. Cup is short, may be flanged; petals are often flat, fairly broad, and rounded. Spring-flowering.
- Div. 8 Tazetta**—sweetly fragrant flowers of small-flowered cultivars are borne in clusters of 12 or more per stem; large-flowered cultivars have 3 or 4 flowers per stem. All have a small, often straight-sided cup and broad, mostly pointed petals. Late fall- to mid-spring-flowering. Most are frost to half hardy. Fall-flowering hybrids provide valuable cut flowers; “prepared” bulbs may be grown in pots for mid-winter flowering.
- Div. 9 Poeticus**—flowers, sometimes borne 2 per stem, may be sweetly fragrant. Each has a small, colored cup and glistening white petals. Some *N. poeticus* hybrids are categorized as Div. 3 or 8. Late spring- or early summer-flowering.
- Div. 10 Bulbocodium**—flowers usually borne singly on short stems, showing all the hallmarks of hoop-petticoat daffodils (*N. bulbocodium* subsp. *bulbocodium*), with insignificant petals and a widely flaring, disproportionately large cup. Winter- to spring-flowering.
- Div. 11 Split-corona**—usually solitary flowers with cups split for more than half their length. In **(a)**, Collar daffodils, the overlapping cup segments lie against the petals. In **(b)**, Papillon daffodils, the cup segments tend to be narrower, with their tips at the margin of the petals. Most fall into category (a). Spring-flowering.
- Div. 12 Miscellaneous**—a miscellaneous category containing hybrids with varying, intermediate flower shapes that cannot be satisfactorily classified elsewhere. Fall- to spring-flowering.
- Div. 13 Daffodils distinguished solely by botanical name**—a wide variety of flowers showing the huge range of floral characteristics of wild daffodils, from the tiny *N. cyclamineus* and the sweetly scented, many-flowered *N. tazetta* to the stately trumpet species. Flower in early fall to early summer.

N. ‘Acropolis’, Div. 4. Mid-to late spring-flowering bulb. H 28in (70cm). Large, double flowers have white, outer petals and petaloids; white, inner petals are interspersed with shorter, orange-red petaloids. Suitable for exhibition. Z3–7 **N. ‘Actaea’** (illus. p.404), Div. 9. Late spring-flowering bulb. H 28in (70cm). Fragrant flowers have glistening white petals and shallow, flanged, rich lemon cups with narrow, orange-red rims. Z3–7 **N. ‘Aircastle’** (illus. p.405), Div. 3. Mid-spring-flowering bulb. H 16in (40cm). Flowers have white petals that age greenish; shallow, flat, lemon-yellow cups deepen in color at the rim. Z3–7 **N. ‘Albus Plenus Odoratus’**. See *N. poeticus* ‘Plenus’.